

divinely inspired, thereby strengthening its emotional and moral appeal to the audience.

## Task 2: Climb the Ladder

- **Text:** Poem - "The Red Wheelbarrow" by William Carlos Williams
- **Quotation 引用:** "so much depends / upon / a red wheel / barrow"
- **Describe (What?):** The poem is composed of four short, two-line stanzas. The first stanza states "so much depends upon," and the following three stanzas break down the image of "a red wheel barrow" into its component parts.
- **Analyze (How?):** Williams uses a highly fragmented structure to force the reader to slow down and examine each part of the scene meticulously. The stark, simple imagery ("red," "glazed with rain / water," "white chickens") is presented without adornment or explanation.
- **Interpret (So What?):** By asserting that "so much depends" on this simple, mundane scene, the poet elevates it to a position of immense significance. The poem suggests that profound meaning and stability can be found in the ordinary, functional objects of the world, if only we pause to observe them with focused attention.

## Task 3: Draft an Analytical PEEL Paragraph

**(P) Point 论点:** William Carlos Williams, through his deliberate structural fragmentation, compels the reader to find profound significance in an otherwise ordinary object.

**(E) Evidence 证据:** He breaks the simple phrase "a red wheel barrow" across three stanzas: "a red wheel / barrow / glazed with rain / water," forcing a slow, piece-by-piece visualization.

**(E) Explanation 解释 (Your Analysis):** This technique of enjambment and isolation does not just describe the wheelbarrow; it replicates the act of careful observation. By making the reader assemble the image word by word, Williams mimics how the eye might slowly scan the scene, noticing first the color, then the object, and finally the rain's effect. This process forces a heightened awareness, transforming the wheelbarrow from a mere tool into a precise and luminous focal point.

**(L) Link 连接:** Therefore, the poem's structure itself is the primary mechanism for achieving its theme, demonstrating that the value of the object is intrinsically tied to the quality of attention we pay to it.

## How This Assignment Affects Your Grade

1. **Teacher Evaluation:** Using the rubric, the teacher would evaluate the example as follows:
  - **Task 1:** Excellent (Clear distinction; analysis insightfully examines the "dream" metaphor).
  - **Task 2:** Excellent (Ladder is fully and thoughtfully completed with a nuanced "So What?").
  - **Task 3:** Excellent (A coherent PEEL paragraph with a strong Point and deep Explanation that connects structure to theme).
  - **Total Score: 10 out of 10.**
2. **Integration into Final Grade:** This score of **10/10** is added to your other coursework scores. The resulting **Coursework Average** is then multiplied by **0.25** to determine its contribution to your final grade.

# Chapter 11: The Problem-Solution Essay

第十一章：问题解决型文章 (Wèntí jiějué xíng wénzhāng)

**Your Goal for This Chapter 本章目标 (Běn zhāng mùbiāo):** To move beyond identifying problems and learn to propose, evaluate, and convincingly argue for viable, well-reasoned solutions.

超越识别问题，学习提出、评估并有说服力地论证可行、合理的解决方案。

## Lesson 11.1: Beyond Complaining - The Anatomy of a Solution

第一课：超越抱怨——解决方案的剖析 (Chāoyuè bàoyuàn——Jiějué fāng'àn de pōuxī)

### Part 1: Defining a True Problem

定义一个真正的问题 (Dìngyì yīgè zhēnzhèng de wèntí)

A **problem 问题 (wèntí)** for an essay is not just a bad situation. It is a specific issue with **consequences 后果 (hòuguǒ)** that has **potential for change 改变的潜力 (gǎibiàn de qiánli)**.

- **Vague "Problem":** "Social media is bad."  
模糊的“问题”：“社交媒体不好。”
- **Well-Defined Problem:** "The constant, algorithmically-driven comparison to curated lives on social media is linked to rising anxiety and decreased self-esteem among adolescents, creating a public health concern."  
定义清晰的问题：“在社交媒体上持续地、由算法驱动地与经过修饰的生活进行比较，与青少年日益增长的焦虑和下降的自尊有关，这造成了一个公共健康问题。”

A good problem statement makes your reader care and understand why a solution is necessary.

一个好的问题陈述能让你的读者关心并理解为什么需要解决方案。

## Part 2: Qualities of a Strong Solution

优秀解决方案的特质 (Yōuxiù jiějué fāng'àn de tèzhì)

A **solution 解决方案 (jiějué fāng'àn)** is not just an idea. It is a concrete proposal that is:

解决方案不只是一个想法。它是一个具体的提议，具有以下特点：

1. **Feasible 可行的 (Kěxíng de):** It is practical and possible to implement. (Who will do it? What will it cost? Is it legal?)  
它是实用且可以实施的。（谁来做？成本是多少？合法吗？）
2. **Effective 有效的 (Yǒuxiào de):** It directly addresses the root cause of the problem and will likely make a significant impact.  
它直接解决问题的根本原因，并可能产生重大影响。
3. **Defensible 可辩护的 (Kě biànhù de):** Its benefits outweigh its potential drawbacks. You can argue for it against other options.  
它的好处大于潜在的缺点。你可以为其辩护，反对其他选项。

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## Lesson 11.2: Structuring the Argument

第二课：构建论证 (Gòujiàn lùnzheng)

The problem-solution essay follows a powerful and logical structure.

问题解决型文章遵循一个强大且符合逻辑的结构。



## Part 1: Making the Case - The Problem Section

提出理由——问题部分 (Tíchū lǐyóu——Wèntí bùfèn)

This section must convince the reader the problem is serious and worth solving. Use your research to provide evidence of: 这一部分必须说服读者问题很严重，值得解决。用你的研究提供证据证明：

- **Scope 范围 (Fànwéi):** How widespread is the problem? (Statistics, data)  
问题有多普遍？（统计数据）
- **Severity 严重性 (Yánzhòng xìng):** How bad is it? What are the negative consequences? (Case studies, examples)  
它有多严重？有什么负面后果？（案例研究，例子）
- **Causes 原因 (Yuányīn):** What is the root cause? (Expert analysis, reports)  
根本原因是什么？（专家分析，报告）

## Part 2: Proposing the Fix - The Solution Section

提出解决方案——解决方案部分 (Tíchū jiějué fāng'àn——Jiějué fāng'àn bùfèn)

This is where you become a problem-solver. You must explain:

这是你成为问题解决者的地方。你必须解释：

- **The Plan 计划 (Jìhuà):** What, specifically, should be done? Be concrete.  
具体应该做什么？要具体。
- **Feasibility 可行性 (Kěxíng xìng):** Why can this be done? Discuss cost, time, logistics, and existing examples.  
为什么这可以做到？讨论成本、时间、物流和现有例子。
- **Effectiveness 有效性 (Yǒuxiào xìng):** Why *should* this be done? How will it directly solve the problem you outlined?  
Predict the positive outcomes.  
为什么应该这样做？它将如何直接解决你概述的问题？预测积极的结果。

## Part 3: Anticipating Objections - The Counterargument

预测反对意见——反论部分 (Yùcè fǎnduì yìjiàn——Fǎnlùn bùfèn)

A strong solution acknowledges its own potential weaknesses. A dedicated paragraph strengthens your credibility. 一个强大的解决方案会承认自己潜在的弱点。一个专门写反论的段落会增强你的可信度。

- **They Say...** "Some may argue that this solution is too expensive to implement."  
**他们说...** “有些人可能认为这个解决方案实施起来太昂贵了。”
- **I Say...** "However, a study by the Economic Policy Institute shows that the long-term healthcare and productivity savings would far outweigh the initial investment. Furthermore, the cost of *inaction* is far greater."  
**我说...** “然而，经济政策研究所的一项研究表明，长期的医疗保健和生产效率节省将远远超过初始投资。此外，不采取行动的代价要大得多。”

## Lesson 11.3: Language for Change

第三课：推动改变的语言 (Tuīdòng gǎibiàn de yǔyán)

Use powerful and persuasive language to frame your argument.  
使用有力和有说服力的语言来构建你的论证。

### Emphasizing the Problem 强调问题:

- "The critical issue of X demands immediate attention..."  
“X这个关键问题需要立即关注...”
- "Unless addressed, this problem will lead to..."  
“除非得到解决，否则这个问题将导致...”
- "The data reveals a troubling trend..."  
“数据揭示了一个令人不安的趋势...”

### Proposing the Solution 提出解决方案:

- "A viable and effective solution would be to..."  
“一个可行且有效的解决方案是...”
- "To mitigate this issue, we must..."  
“为了缓解这个问题，我们必须...”
- "Implementing [solution] would address the root cause by..."  
“实施[解决方案]将通过...解决根本原因”

### Arguing for Feasibility/Effectiveness 论证可行性/有效性:

- "This approach is not only practical but also cost-effective..."  
“这种方法不仅实用，而且具有成本效益...”
- "Pilot programs in [Location] have demonstrated success in..."  
“在[地点]的试点项目已在...方面取得了成功”
- "The primary benefit of this solution is its ability to..."  
“这个解决方案的主要好处是它能够...”

### Call to Action 行动号召:

- "It is imperative that [government/schools/companies] take action by..."  
“[政府/学校/公司]必须采取行动...”
- "We must urge our representatives to prioritize this issue."  
“我们必须敦促我们的代表优先处理这个问题。”
- "By working together, we can solve this problem and create a better..."  
“通过共同努力，我们可以解决这个问题，并创造一个更美好的...”

## Homework: The Solution Architect

作业：解决方案架构师 (Jiějué fāng'àn jiàgòu shī)